

ASPN Platform Release Notes v0.1

June 2026

September MVP Foundation Release

Release Overview

ASPN Platform Release v0.1 represents the completion of the first major backend modernization effort following review of the ASPN Platform Prototype 2025.

The goal of this release was not to launch a finished platform, but to transform the original discussion-board-oriented prototype into a safer and more scalable foundation for:

- Youth Profiles
- Credentialing
- Attendance Tracking
- Service-Hour Verification
- Staff Oversight
- Firebase Authentication
- September 2026 Youth Onboarding

This release focuses entirely on backend infrastructure and platform foundations.

Frontend integration, staging validation, and production launch remain future milestones.

Release Objectives

This release was designed to support the ASPN September MVP by ensuring the platform can eventually provide:

- Private youth profiles
- Staff-awarded credentials
- Attendance records
- Service-hour records

- Staff-managed onboarding
- Youth self-service profile retrieval

while maintaining:

- Youth safety
 - Privacy
 - Auditability
 - Administrative oversight
-

Original Prototype Baseline

Before Release v0.1, the platform primarily supported:

- User profiles
- Discussion posts
- Comments
- Upvotes
- Firebase/Firestore integration

The platform lacked:

- Credential management
 - Credential display
 - Attendance tracking
 - Service-hour tracking
 - Staff role protection
 - Youth self-service profile retrieval
 - Staff onboarding workflows
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Completed Development Checkpoints

Testing Setup Foundation

Status

Completed

Purpose

Allow local testing without requiring live Firebase credentials.

Outcome

- Local builds pass successfully.
 - Testing no longer depends on production Firebase access.
 - Development workflow is significantly more stable.
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Checkpoint 1: Backend Cleanup

Status

Completed

Major Improvements

- Fixed Firestore collection inconsistencies.
- Fixed post deletion behavior.
- Improved error handling.
- Added compatibility route for create-post requests.
- Removed unused code.

Outcome

Backend stability significantly improved.

Checkpoint 2: Profile Foundation

Status

Completed

Major Improvements

Added profile support for:

- Program participation
- Credentials
- Attendance
- Service hours
- Staff review
- Staff verification

Outcome

Youth profiles now function as the central platform record.

Checkpoint 3: Credential Foundation

Status

Completed

Major Improvements

Added:

- CredentialDefinition model
- EarnedCredential model

Credential definitions support:

- Credential ID
- Name
- Description
- Icon
- Category
- Active status

Outcome

Credential system architecture established.

No credential catalog created yet.

Checkpoint 4: Staff Credential Management

Status

Completed

New Routes

None

POST /api/staff/credentials/definitions

POST /api/staff/credentials/award

Outcome

Staff-controlled credential creation and awarding foundation established.

Youth self-awarding remains disabled.

Checkpoint 5: Credential Display

Status

Completed

New Route

None

GET /api/getUserWithCredentials/{id}

Outcome

Profiles can now retrieve credential display information.

Supports:

- Credential name
- Description
- Icon
- Category
- Award status
- Award dates

Checkpoint 6: Authentication & Role Protection

Status

Completed

Major Improvements

Implemented:

- Firebase ID token verification
- Staff/Admin role validation

Protected routes:

None

POST /api/staff/credentials/definitions

POST /api/staff/credentials/award

Outcome

Critical credential-management actions now require verified staff access.

Checkpoint 7: Staff User Management

Status

Completed

New Routes

None

GET /api/staff/users/youth

GET /api/staff/users/youth/{id}

PATCH /api/staff/users/youth/{id}

Outcome

Staff onboarding and profile review workflows established.

Checkpoint 8: Attendance Foundation

Status

Completed

New Routes

None

`POST /api/staff/attendance`

`GET /api/staff/attendance/user/{userID}`

Outcome

Attendance tracking architecture established.

Supported statuses:

None

`present`

`absent`

`excused`

`pending`

Checkpoint 9: Service-Hour Foundation

Status

Completed

New Routes

None

POST /api/staff/service-hours

GET /api/staff/service-hours/user/{userID}

Outcome

Service-hour tracking architecture established.

Placeholder support added for future Google Form integration.

No Google Form integration currently exists.

Checkpoint 10: Youth Self-Service Profile

Status

Completed

New Route

None

GET /api/me/profile

Outcome

Youth can retrieve:

- Profile information
- Credentials
- Attendance records
- Service-hour records

using their authenticated Firebase identity.

Youth cannot retrieve another user's profile.

Checkpoint 11: Firebase Staging Readiness Review

Status

Completed

Outcome

Backend determined structurally ready for:

- Firebase staging deployment
- Firebase authentication testing
- Firestore testing
- September MVP validation

Production deployment is not yet recommended.

Current Platform Capabilities

The backend now supports:

Profiles

- Private youth profiles
- Profile status management
- Program participation tracking
- Staff review flags
- Staff verification flags

Credentials

- Credential definitions
- Earned credentials
- Credential display retrieval
- Staff-controlled credential awarding

Attendance

- Attendance records
- Attendance retrieval
- Attendance-to-profile associations

Service Hours

- Service-hour records
- Verification status tracking
- Service-hour-to-profile associations

Security

- Firebase ID token verification
 - Staff role validation
 - Admin role validation
-

Firestore Collections

Current collections:

None

aspirationnetworkusers
aspirationnetworkposts
comments

credentialDefinitions
earnedCredentials

attendanceRecords
serviceHourRecords

September MVP Readiness Assessment

Ready

Backend foundation for:

- Youth onboarding
- Credentialing
- Attendance tracking
- Service-hour tracking

- Staff oversight
 - Profile retrieval
-

Partially Ready

- Firebase staging deployment
 - Frontend integration
 - Real-world testing
-

Not Ready

Production launch

Additional validation required before production deployment.

Known Limitations

The following features are intentionally incomplete:

Credentialing

- No credential catalog seeded yet
- No credential management interface

Attendance

- No attendance editing workflow
- No QR attendance

Service Hours

- No Google Form integration
- No youth submission workflow

Profiles

- No profile editing workflow
- No public profile discovery

Frontend

- Staff dashboard not built
 - Youth dashboard not built
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Features Explicitly Excluded

The following remain intentionally out of scope:

None

Direct Messaging

Peer-to-Peer Messaging

Followers

Friend Systems

Popularity Rankings

Infinite Scroll

Viral Recommendations

Public Youth Search

Recommended Next Phase

Phase II: Frontend Integration & Staging Validation

Priority order:

1

Firebase staging deployment

2

Frontend profile page

3

Staff dashboard

4

Credential management interface

5

Attendance interface

6

Service-hour interface

7

Staging validation testing

Long-Term Vision

Future platform phases may include:

- Project management
- Program management
- Workforce pathways
- Government pathways
- Scholarship pathways
- College pathways
- Structured civic participation
- Safe discussion systems
- Moderation tools
- Audit logging

Future public-profile functionality should require separate safety review and approval.

Release Summary

Release v0.1 successfully transforms the ASPN Platform from a basic discussion-board prototype into a structured youth-development platform foundation centered on:

- Private profiles
- Credentials
- Attendance
- Service hours
- Staff oversight
- Authentication

The backend is now positioned for Firebase staging validation and frontend integration in preparation for September 2026 onboarding.

Release Date: June 2026

Release Version: ASPN Platform v0.1

Status: Backend Foundation Complete

Next Milestone: Frontend Integration & Firebase Staging Validation